PROJECT 10073 RECORD CARD

4602d AISS

1. DATE
14-13 August 56

2. LOCATION
Bentwaters-Lakenheath, England

3. DATE-TIME GROUP
Local 21200-2220 (13 Aug)
GMT ZONE: 0010-0330 (14 Aug)

4. TYPE OF OBSERVATION
☒ Ground-Visual
☒ Ground-Radar
☒ Air-Visual
☐ Air-Intercept Radar

5. PHOTOS
☐ Yes
☒ No

6. SOURCE
Radar observers - Ground observers, AF pilots

7. LENGTH OF OBSERVATION
Total: Approx 5 hrs

8. NUMBER OF OBJECTS
Varied

9. COURSE
Varied

10. BRIEF SUMMARY OF SIGHTING

1. On 14 August, between 2120-2220 ZI Bentwaters radar reported 3 separate UFO tracks suddenly appearing and disappearing on their screens, within a 2 hr period.

2. Bentwaters station alerted RAF radar unit at Lakenheath. On 14 Aug the RAF unit reported objs were observed intermittently from 0010Z to 0330Z, going from W to SW, stopping for 5 minutes, thence NW, disappearing from scope at 0330Z.

11. COMMENTS (ATIC)

At first glance, the 2 messages (TT Msgs 301-435, 16 Aug 56 and IDO-7335, 21 Aug 56) reporting this sighting may give the impression that observations, radar, ground and air, were simultaneous. A review of detailed report IR-1-56, dtd 31 Aug 56, indicates that, although the observations took place within the periods given, they cannot be considered as concurrent.

12. CONCLUSIONS
☐ Was Balloon
☐ Probably Balloon
☐ Possibly Balloon
☐ Was Aircraft
☐ Probably Aircraft
☐ Possibly Aircraft
☐ Was Astronomical
☐ Probably Astronomical
☐ Possibly Astronomical
☐ Other Anam. Propagation
☐ Insufficient Data for Evaluation
☐ Unknown

ATIC FORM 329 (REV 26 SEP 52)

[redacted] UNCLASSIFIED

SUBJECT: Report for Analysis - UFO Reports from CINCUSAFE, Wiesbaden and Lakeheath, England

TO: AFOIN-4E4
Attn: Capt. Gregory

FROM: AFOIN-4E1

DATE 31 Aug 56 COMMENT NO. 2
AFOIN-4E1a/Mr.Bryant/pm/72131

1. From the incomplete information submitted, it is impossible to make a definite determination of the sources of these sightings. Certain facts which are available, however, do tend to indicate that the targets were due to weather conditions. For example, the fact that a number of blips appeared and disappeared intermittently are characteristic of weather returns on radar; this characteristic frequently leads to a mistaken observation that one target has moved at tremendous speed, where in reality one has faded out or disappeared and another appeared at a different location on the scope. This also explains the erratic movement of the supposed target. Another characteristic of weather returns is the disappearance of all the targets in question at about the same time. This is due to rapid atmospheric changes wherein conditions change from favorable for anomalous propagation to normal conditions.

2. The fact that the visual and radar sightings were not simultaneous tends to preclude the possibility of the targets being material targets.

3. A more thorough analysis of these UFO sightings would have been possible if more complete information were available. Pertinent data which is necessary for such analysis includes scope photographs, weather information indicating presence or lack of temperature inversion, moisture lapse data, and an accurate tabulation of related times and places of sightings (as between visual and electronic sightings). This is not intended to infer negligence or lack of capability of reporting personnel; such oversights or omissions are natural during such times, and data of this type may not be available even if considered.

Incls
5 Incls w/d-1 - 5

GORDON C. HOFFMAN
Colonel, USAF
AFOIN-4E1

CLASSIFICATION CHANGED TO UNCLASSIFIED, EFFECTIVE 15 MARCH 1966, UNDER THE AUTHORITY OF AFR 205-1, PARA 2-176(ii), BY Maj Hector Quintanilla, Jr. H. Quintanilla Jr.

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[redacted]

[redacted]

REPORT NR.: IR-1-56 EXTRACT "A" UNCLASSIFIED BEB

ORIGINATING AGENCY: 81st Fighter Bomber Wing, England

DATE OF DOCUMENT: 8/31/56

SUBJECT: (Unclassified) Unidentified Flying Objects Reporting (UFOB)

RETRIEVAL INFO: 4E4I/1 - England/--------/UFOB/----------

ATIC NR. 293634

AF NR. 1025624

REFERENCES

Most significant are the reports of three courses of UFOBS tracked on the Bentwaters GCA Radar. These UFOBS flew courses as follows: 1 group of 12 to 15 UFOBS FROM a point 8 miles SW of Bentwaters to approximately 40-45 miles NE of Bentwaters at an estimated speed of 80 to 125 miles per hour; a single UFOB was tracked by the Bentwaters GCA from approximately 25 miles SE of Bentwaters to approximately 15 miles NW of Bentwaters at a speed estimated at more than 4,000 miles per hour; a third UFOB was reported as tracked by the Bentwaters GCA from approximately 30 miles E. of Bentwaters flying a westerly course to about 30 miles west of Bentwaters at an exceptionally high speed.

The GCA Operators making these radar sightings were of the opinion that malfunctions of the GCA Equipment did not cause these radar sightings.

The following information was obtained from USAF personnel assigned to RAF Station, Bentwaters, England concerning visual and radar sightings of Unidentified Flying Objects in the vicinity of their assigned station during the period 2120Z to 2220Z, 13 August 1956. The reliability of all the following sources of information is estimated to be usually reliable.

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ATIC NR. 293634
AF NR. 1025624
REFERENCES

S/Sgt [redacted]

On 27 August 1956 the following information concerning subject Unidentified Flying Objects was received from S/Sgt [redacted], Control Tower Shift Chief, 1264th AACS Squadron, RAF Station Bentwaters, England.

Sgt [redacted] indicated that his attention was first called to the object by its position, size and unusual color. He was also aware that the Bentwaters GCA was tracking Unidentified Flying Objects by radar at this time. Sgt [redacted] described the UFOB as spherical and the size of a pin-head held at arms length. He sighted only one object which was described as amber color when first observed later changing to bluish-white. No discernable details or features were observed and no sound from the object was noted. Sgt Wright sighted the object from the Bentwaters Control Tower visually with the aid of 7 X 50 power binoculars. Time of his sighting was between 2120Z and 2220Z, 13 August 1956. He indicated that the object was first observed at about 10° elevation toward the south east. The object was in sight for approximately one hour during which time it intermittently disappeared and reappeared. At the time of the object's disappearance, it was located approximately 40° above the horizon in south south-easterly direction. Light conditions during sighting: dusk to night. Sgt [redacted] indicated that the sky was clear with unlimited visibility during the time of this observation.

[illegible] at that time, [illegible]
for [illegible] attempt [illegible] accurate elevation from the horizon [illegible]

T/Sgt [redacted].
([illegible] Z)

T/Sgt [redacted] GCA Operator, 1264th AACS Squadron, RAF Station Bentwaters, England reported the following information relative to subject Unidentified Flying Objects.

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